



COUNTY Supervisor Lindsey Horvath, right, and ex-Vice President Kamala Harris visit Pacific Palisades with a fire official this month.

Zelensky and Trump trade barbs over war

The Ukrainian is called a ‘dictator’ by U.S. leader, who he says echoes Russian disinformation.

BY HANNA ARHIROVA AND JUSTIN SPIKE

KYIV, Ukraine — Relations between Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky and President Trump deteriorated rapidly on Wednesday as Zelensky said Trump was living in a Russian-made “disinformation space” and Trump called Zelensky “a dictator without elections” in comments that were sure to complicate efforts to end the war.

Zelensky also said he would like Trump’s team “to be more truthful” as he offered his first response to a series of claims that Trump made a day earlier, including falsely suggesting that Kyiv was to blame for the war, which enters its fourth year next week.

The comments were a staggering back-and-forth between leaders of two countries that have been staunch allies in recent years under Trump’s predecessor. While former President Biden was in the White House, the U.S. provided crucial military equipment to Kyiv to fend off the invasion and used its political weight to defend Ukraine and isolate Russia on the world stage.

The Trump administration has started charting a new course for the U.S., reaching out to Russia and pushing for a peace deal. Senior officials from both countries held talks Tuesday to discuss improving ties, negotiating an end to the war and potentially preparing a meeting between Trump and Russian President Vladimir Putin after years of frosty relations.

[See U.S.-Ukraine, A4]



ALLEN J. SCHABEN Los Angeles Times

IRVINE’S Orchard Hills neighborhood is designed with numerous levels of defense against wildfire. Homes are built with noncombustible materials, and the enclave is surrounded by a wall and open space.

Planning, design protected O.C. enclave in 2020 blaze. Are there lessons for L.A.?

Buffer zone, building materials, other efforts paid off for residents

BY JACK FLEMMING

Four years before the Palisades and Eaton fires ravaged L.A. County, Irvine braced for a blaze of its own.

A bone-dry summer left the landscape parched and primed to ignite as Santa Ana winds roared through the region at 80 mph. On the morning of Oct. 26, 2020, the Silverado fire erupted.

Firefighters deployed. The city

initiated its emergency plan. Residents of Orchard Hills — a master-planned community straddling the wildland-urban interface and sitting in the path of the quickly growing fire — fled, not knowing whether they’d ever see their homes again.

All of them would. The flames licked at the neighborhood’s outskirts, toasting a few leaves at the perimeter, but didn’t damage a single residence in the community.

The battle against the fire was an

unequivocal victory — a product of the meticulous planning of the neighborhood, the design of its homes and the painstaking plan set in place by the city.

As L.A. looks to fortify itself against future fires, Orchard Hills could serve as the road map to get there.

Of course, the comparison isn’t exact. Irvine is a newer city with modern homes built using lessons [See Fire resistance, A9]

2nd bear moves into a home evacuated during Eaton fire

BY CLARA HARTER

A second black bear has taken up tenancy in the crawl space of a home evacuated during the Eaton fire, prompting local frustration and fear about the creature’s destructive capabilities.

The bear has been making himself comfortable, lounging by the pool during the day and bringing food back to the crawl space from neighbors’ trash at night, said homeowner Sean Lorenzini.

“I think it found refuge under the house during the

fire,” he said, “and it’s definitely not moving—that’s its home.”

The bear has left claw marks on neighborhood trash bins, torn insulation from underneath the house and is probably the culprit behind several broken fuses as well as a recent attack on

his neighbor’s pet goat, he said. Lorenzini estimates it weighs 500 to 600 pounds.

And Lorenzini is not the only local to discover an unbearable problem when returning home after the fire.

At the end of January, an Altadena homeowner could [See Bear, A6]

Texts reveal tension with mayor

Private messages show Supervisor Horvath and Bass’ relationship straining as they dealt with Palisades fire.

BY JULIA WICK

Los Angeles was still deep in crisis on Jan. 21 when county Supervisor Lindsey Horvath made her frustration known to Mayor Karen Bass.

The Palisades fire was only partially contained. Forecasters had issued a rare alert amid vicious winds, warning that new fires could spark. And the first rain of the season was expected soon, meaning mud and debris could slide down scorched hillsides.

Bass was still struggling to regain her political footing after stumbling badly in the days after the fire broke out. City and county officials had been holding daily news conferences together — until that morning and the previous morning, when Bass spoke to reporters without her county counterparts.

Behind closed doors, those appearances, and other issues involving cooperation and communication, had become a topic of contention between two of the most powerful women in Los Angeles, as a lengthy text message that Horvath sent Bass at 9:11 that morning reveals.

“You asked us to lay off the daily pressers. We did. We asked you to join us for this announcement tomorrow. No response. Now we hear you’re doing one without us today when we are in lead role at your Depts’ request?” wrote Horvath, whose district includes Pacific Palisades.

“Doesn’t feel very ‘locked [See Tension, A7]

U.S. ends legal aid for child migrants

BY RACHEL URANGA

The Trump administration has halted a program that provided lawyers to nearly 26,000 immigrant children, some too young to read or speak, who are or were under the custody of the Office of Refugee Resettlement.

The children — about 4,000 of whom live in California — face deportation, and many don’t have parents or legal guardians in the country.

The Interior Department on Tuesday ordered the Acacia Center for Justice, which coordinates the federally funded program that paid the attorneys, “to stop work.” In its letter, the agency cited contracting rules to justify the program pause, but did not offer clear reasons why.

“The stop work order is being implemented due to causes outside of your [See Immigration, A6]

Cronin blames players and fans

UCLA men’s basketball coach points the finger after the Bruins blow a lead in loss. **SPORTS, B10**

A dozen gray wolves collared

Wildlife officials hope to track the species seeing “stunning” population growth. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Meta will build underwater cable

World’s longest internet connectivity line would link the U.S. and other regions. **BUSINESS, A8**

Weather

Sunny. L.A. Basin: 71/51. **B6**

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